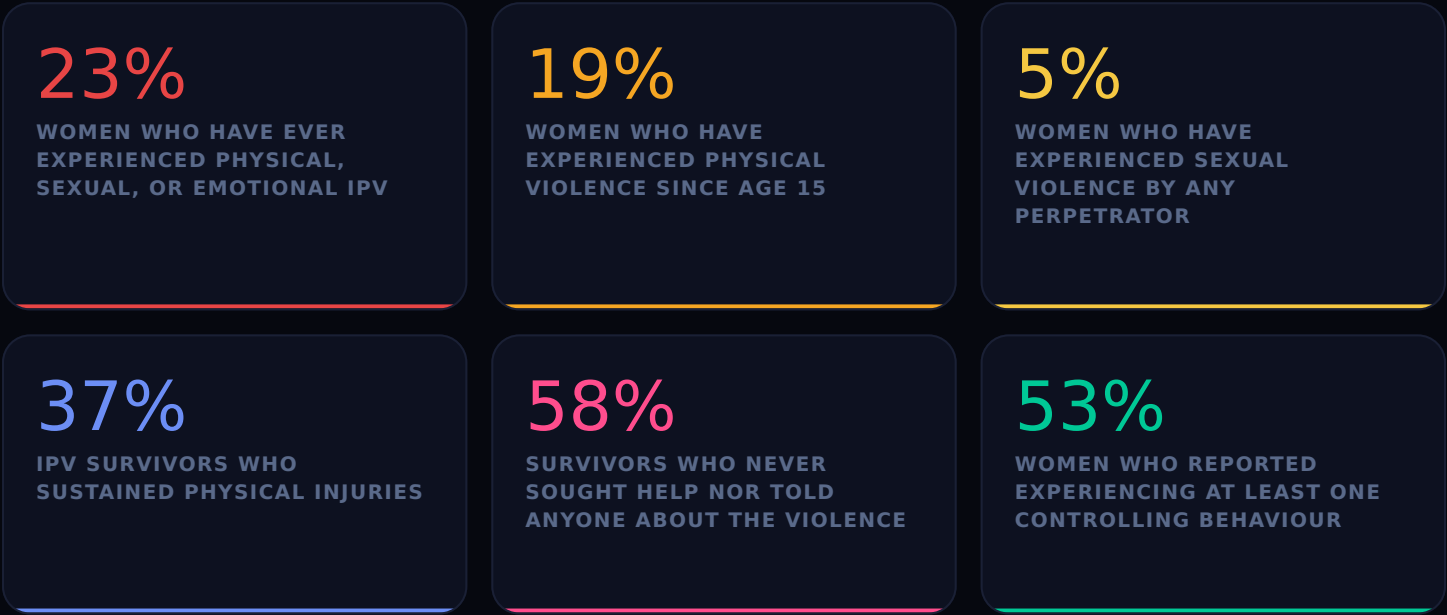


Domestic Violence in Nigeria

A data-driven analysis of intimate partner violence across Nigeria's six geopolitical zones and top 13 states, using the Nigeria Demographic and Health Survey (NDHS) 2024.

NATIONAL OVERVIEW — KEY FIGURES



Context & Scope

- ▶ This analysis covers intimate partner violence (IPV) — physical, sexual, and emotional — among women age 15-49 who have ever had a husband or intimate partner.
- ▶ IPV nationally stands at 23%, a decline from 36% in 2018 and 25% in 2013, showing some progress but still a significant public health concern.
- ▶ The current or most recent husband/intimate partner is the perpetrator in 55% of physical violence cases and 70% of sexual violence cases.
- ▶ Women whose fathers beat their mothers are more than twice as likely to experience IPV (49% vs 21%), highlighting the intergenerational cycle of violence.

Domestic Violence by Region

% OF WOMEN WHO HAVE EVER EXPERIENCED ANY IPV (PHYSICAL, SEXUAL OR EMOTIONAL) — BY GEOPOLITICAL ZONE



IPV BREAKDOWN BY TYPE AND ZONE

ZONE	EMOTIONAL	PHYSICAL	SEXUAL	ANY IPV
South South	27.2%	22.3%	4.5%	35.2%
South East	24.8%	21.2%	3.2%	30.7%
North Central	20.3%	14.5%	4.0%	24.8%
North West	17.4%	8.2%	4.4%	20.9%
South West	16.5%	12.9%	3.0%	20.2%
North East	13.3%	9.1%	3.7%	17.3%
National Average	18.9%	12.8%	3.9%	23.4%

Regional Insights

- ▶ South South leads with 35.2% — more than double the national average, driven by high rates across all three forms of violence.
- ▶ South East ranks second at 30.7%, with Ebonyi and Anambra states recording some of the highest figures in the zone.
- ▶ North East records the lowest rate (17.3%), though underreporting may be a factor given cultural and security-related barriers to disclosure.
- ▶ Emotional violence is the most prevalent form of IPV across all six zones, led by the South South (27.2%) and South East (24.8%).

Top 13 States by IPV Prevalence

% OF WOMEN WHO HAVE EVER EXPERIENCED ANY IPV (PHYSICAL, SEXUAL OR EMOTIONAL) — RANKED

#	STATE	ZONE	EMOTIONAL	PHYSICAL	SEXUAL	ANY IPV
1	Sokoto	North West	45.6%	14.2%	5.5%	46.7%
2	Ebonyi	South East	37.9%	24.3%	3.9%	42.2%
3	Cross River	South South	27.9%	27.3%	2.2%	41.7%
4	Ekiti	South West	37.0%	19.8%	5.0%	42.6%
5	Bayelsa	South South	29.5%	28.4%	11.1%	42.7%
6	Nasarawa	North Central	33.1%	22.7%	6.5%	40.0%
7	Plateau	North Central	30.8%	24.2%	7.8%	37.4%
8	Benue	North Central	30.9%	26.2%	3.6%	35.9%
9	Delta	South South	36.0%	22.8%	3.5%	38.1%
10	Edo	South South	29.1%	20.2%	3.4%	37.9%
11	Anambra	South East	25.3%	29.7%	1.9%	37.1%
12	Abia	South East	26.9%	24.0%	6.5%	33.6%
13	Gombe	North East	30.4%	8.2%	2.0%	31.4%

Key State-Level Findings

- ▶ Sokoto ranks #1 nationally at 46.7%, driven overwhelmingly by emotional violence (45.6%) — the highest emotional IPV of any state.
- ▶ Bayelsa records the highest sexual IPV (11.1%) of all states, and also leads in physical violence within the South South zone.
- ▶ Cross River and Anambra stand out for high physical violence rates (27.3% and 29.7%) exceeding even their emotional violence figures.
- ▶ 10 of the top 13 states are from the South or North Central zones — confirming the regional patterns seen on Page 2.
- ▶ Kebbi records the lowest IPV rate nationally at just 2.2%, compared to Sokoto's 46.7% — both in the same North West zone, showing sharp within-zone disparities.